



INDIA IS ON the cusp of a technological revolution and what we do now will decide the fate of billions of lives. With its young, dynamic population, burgeoning economy, and vibrant tech ecosystem, the country is well-positioned to be a digital frontrunner. The next five years will be pivotal in shaping India's digital destiny and regulations around tech could be the fuel required to achieve that goal.

India's journey towards a tech-empowered future by 2029 depends on strategic planning, effective regulation, and nurturing a skilled workforce. The country's success in this endeavour will shape not only its economy but also its standing on the global stage. A significant challenge will be balancing rapid technological advancement with robust data security and privacy laws. The government's role will be pivotal in creating policies that foster growth while protecting citizens' rights.

India's five-year agenda for tech regulation will rest on five pillars.

DATA PRIVACY

The digital era has brought concerns about data privacy and secu-

rity, prompting India to introduce the landmark Digital Personal Data Protection Act (DPDPA) of 2023. According to Shreya Suri, Partner at the law firm INDUS-LAW, the DPDPA's implementation hinges on awareness about compliance obligations and the rights of data principals. This law enforces stringent data security responsibilities on organisations and emphasises the protection of individual privacy rights. Suri claims organisations must establish robust grievance mechanisms for data principals to raise concerns, ensuring compliance and effective grievance redressal.

"The DPDPA is fairly robust and the penalties contemplated for different kinds of violations act as much as a deterring factor as any for data fiduciaries. A lot of aspects, of course, have been left to subjective interpretation in the Act and may not be supplemented by further rules. In such situations, organisations must seek sound legal advice while determining its compliance requirements," she says.

TECH INNOVATION HUB

India's aspiration to become a global hub for tech innovation

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BRIDGING THE DIGITAL DIVIDE

Enhancing internet penetration, digital literacy, and tech-focussed education

ONLINE GRIEVANCE MANAGEMENT

Developing mechanisms to address online harms like cyber bullying and misinformation

ETHICAL AI USE

Ethical guidelines for AI can ensure transparency and address biases, especially in critical areas like law enforcement